

The early American tavern owner didn't ask "what do we serve?" They asked "How do we serve the people?" Answer that question for your venue before you turn the page.

1

THE CORE EXERCISE

DEFINE YOUR VENUE'S AMBIANCE

In 2–3 sentences, describe the **the moment** at your venue that turns customers into a tribe — not just diners. Be specific: name the moment, name who comes, name what they feel. Then identify one historical parallel from this chapter.

YOUR VENUE'S GATHERING MOMENT:

e.g., "Friday pre-game tailgate for Orlando Magic season ticket holders who have sat in the same section for 3+ years"

WHO COMES? WHAT BRINGS THEM BACK?

e.g., "The same 40 fans, same seats, same rituals — the food is the reason; the sense of community is the product"

YOUR HISTORICAL PARALLEL:

e.g., "The Green Dragon — a fixed location where regulars built identity and action around shared beliefs"

WHAT FRICTION PREVENTS THIS EXPERIENCE FROM HAPPENING CONSISTENTLY?

e.g., "Long concession lines break the ritual — the crew disperses before the second half"

Continued on next page →